

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 305

By Yarbro

A RESOLUTION to honor the enduring legacy of Juno Frankie Pierce of Nashville.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those historic citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, distinguished themselves as intrepid leaders whose contributions have echoed through ages; and

WHEREAS, one such individual was Juno Frankie Pierce, founder of the Tennessee Vocational School for Colored Girls, who most assuredly changed the course of countless lives and improved the well-being of generations; and

WHEREAS, born in 1864 to Nellie Seay, who was enslaved by a Smith County lawmaker, Frankie Pierce attended the McKee School, a private school for African Americans in Nashville formed as a mission of the Presbyterian Church; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pierce lived to be ninety years old and is buried in the Greenwood Cemetery in Nashville; and

WHEREAS, during her remarkable lifetime, Frankie Pierce served as president of the Negro Women's Reconstruction League and was the founder of the Nashville Federation of Colored Women's Clubs; she used her platform to uplift the voices of Black women in Nashville and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, in May 1920, she was invited to the state suffragette convention held in the House chamber of the Tennessee Capitol; while there, she is noted as having stated, "We want recognition in all forms of this government. We want a state vocational school and a child welfare department of the state, and more room in state schools"; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Pierce advocated for a vocational school for African-American girls to be on the legislative agenda; in 1921, the General Assembly passed a bill creating and recognizing the school; and

WHEREAS, the campus of Tennessee State University is home to the first collegiate chapter of NACWC, formally known as the National Association of Colored Women's Clubs, Incorporated, Women of Empowerment, the Frankie J. Pierce Federated Chapter; and

WHEREAS, the Frankie J. Pierce Federated Chapter of the NACWC is a select group of like-minded young women who are dedicated to civic participation, campus involvement, and, most importantly, community service; and

WHEREAS, the work of this esteemed chapter is a reminder of the roots Frankie Pierce established during her nine decades of life and her lifetime of devoted advocacy and community service; and

WHEREAS, the life and legacy of Frankie Pierce continue to have an impact on Nashville; her tenacity and sincere desire to help others remains an inspiration to many; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the life and legacy of Juno Frankie Pierce, founder of the Tennessee Vocational School for Colored Girls in Nashville, reflecting fondly on her profound, enduring impact on the State of Tennessee and its citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.